

Does a Reason Reach?

TOK · Knowledge & the Knower · Lesson 2 | Name: _____ Class: _____
Group: _____

Part 1 — Farmer John

1. Before the reveal: did John *know* Betsy was in the field? Circle one — **YES / NO / SPLIT** — and give your reason.

2. After the reveal. Fill in the three boxes for Farmer John.

WAS IT TRUE?	DID HE BELIEVE IT?	WHAT WAS HIS REASON — AND WHAT WAS WRONG WITH IT?

3. Finish this sentence in your own words: *John's reason and the truth ended up in the same place, but...*

4. The stopped clock and the aching knee have the same shape as the cow. In one sentence, what is that shape?

The tool. You know something when (1) it is true, (2) you believe it, (3) you have a good reason — *and* (4) your reason **reaches** the claim: it connects to the thing that makes the claim true, instead of landing nearby by accident.

Part 2 — The Elder

5. Before the reveal: *before* the archive was checked, did the Elder have a justified true belief? Run the three boxes.

TRUE?	BELIEVED?	GOOD REASON? SAY WHY OR WHY NOT.

6. What exactly did the archive add that the Elder did not already have?

7. **Think hard about this one.** Nothing inside the Elder's head changed on the day of the check. If the archive is what turned his belief into knowledge, does that mean a community that keeps no written records holds no knowledge? Answer in three or four sentences.

Before you write: the Elder had the right names for four hundred years. Ask yourself what you think the archive *added* — a new fact, or something else?

Part 3 — Sort the cards

Write your group's letter for each card **before** you check it on screen. **A** = the reason reaches. **B** = hollow, points at nothing checkable. **C** = lucky, a Farmer John.

CARD	THE REASON, IN THREE OR FOUR WORDS	OURS	ACTUAL	IF WE GOT IT WRONG — WHY?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
16				
17*				
18*				

* Pair 9 (cards 17 and 18) only if you have time.

8. List the card numbers you marked **C**. These are your Farmer Johns.

9. What do all the **A** cards have that none of the others do? One sentence.

Part 4 — The Authority Repair

Full stop: *the textbook says so.* End of conversation.

Pointer: *the textbook says so, AND here is why it is trusted on this topic, AND here is what would show it to be wrong.*

Move 1. Name the authority, specifically.

Move 2. Say why it is trusted *on this kind of claim*. ← the one that matters

Move 3. Say what would show the authority is wrong.

10. Stage 1 — the Harvard MBA (watch it done). After the worked example: in one sentence, why did the three moves *reject* this appeal even though the qualification is real?

Copy this down and keep it: a pointer is an evaluation, not an endorsement.

11. Stage 2 — the approved medicine (do it together). *This new medicine is safe, because the national health authority approved it.* Write your own answer to each move **before** your group reveals.

MOVE	YOUR ANSWER
1. Name the authority specifically	
2. Why trusted on <i>this</i> claim? Show the chain behind it	
3. What would show it is wrong? (list as many as you can)	

12. The moves rejected the MBA appeal and accepted this one. The moves did not change. What did?

13. Stage 3 — Jupiter (on your own). Circle the sentence you are repairing:

A. The planet Jupiter has 79 moons, because the textbook says so. | B. The planet Jupiter has 79 moons, because the sacred text says so.

Work the three moves first:

1. Name the authority	
2. Why trusted on this claim?	
3. What would show it wrong?	

Now write the repaired sentence. Keep the claim about Jupiter; change what the sentence *shows*.

Self-check: does your sentence explain *why this source is trusted on this kind of claim*? If it jumps from naming the source straight to what would prove it wrong, you have skipped Move 2 — go back and put it in.

Exit question

14. What makes a reason **good enough**, rather than just **convincing**? (Formal version: what makes a justification *adequate*, rather than merely convincing?)

Warning: “it has evidence” is not yet an answer. The aching knee had evidence.